After the Missile Crisis

As Kennedy had privately promised, the U.S. commitment to refrain from invading Cuba was more cosmetic than real. Sabotage operations were temporarily halted, and MONGOOSE was officially disbanded, replaced by an interagency "Cuban Coordinating Committee."[69] But raids, bombings, and sabotage continued and even increased.[70] The assassination of John F. Kennedy caused a momentary paralysis in the secret war. CIA officials involved in the assassination attempts against Castro feared that Cuban forces might have been involved in the Kennedy assassination in retaliation for CIA attacks on Castro; CIA and FBI officials noted worriedly that both Lee Harvey Oswald and Jack Ruby had possible links to mob figures involved in the Castro assassination plots, and to both pro- and anti-Cuban individuals and organizations. The U.S. government had multiple reasons for wanting to put the lid on investigations into Kennedy's assassination, among them, officials' fears that the U.S. dirty war against Castro and Cuba would be brought into the investigation. No government agency wanted to risk what this line of inquiry might reveal. There was too much to cover up.

In addition to the gambling syndicate route, the CIA cultivated contacts with a "highly placed" Cuban government official, Major Rolando Cubela, starting in early 1961.[71] The CIA arranged to have weapons delivered to Cubela in Cuba in 1963 and again in 1964. In addition, CIA agents delivered a "poison pen" to Cubela in Paris on November 22nd, 1963, with instructions to fill it with Blackleaf 40, an easily available insecticide which would be lethal. "It is likely that at the very moment President Kennedy was shot a CIA officer was meeting with a Cuban agent in Paris and giving him an assassination device for use against Castro," the CIA report concluded.[72]

In June of 1965 CIA officials realized that "the circle of Cubans who knew of Cubela's plans and of CIA's association with them was ever-widening." Cubela had become a security risk, and all contacts with his group were broken. Without CIA support, the plot faltered. Cubela and